



PROGRESS REPORT

South Sudan: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · 140 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-08.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A presidential decree ordering full digitisation set a January 2026 adoption deadline, and the deadline passed without a compliance report. The decree granted an electronic services council full authority over the digitisation of public institutions (decree). The deadline passed and nothing on file records compliance, an extension or a report against it. The country is placed 192nd of 193 on the international electronic government index for 2024. A decree with a deadline and no compliance mechanism is the shape of much of this ledger, and the reason is recorded separately: there is no operating gazette in which an instrument can be published or checked.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The National ICT Policy 2012 is still the standing sector instrument, fourteen years on. The policy covers telecommunications, postal and information technology, and is corroborated as current by the universal service fund's own pages and by a 2022 country diagnostic (policy). The nearest thing to a newer directive is a regulator's circular of April 2026 requiring its licensees to integrate with a single national service platform (circular). No review, successor or delivery report against the 2012 policy appears anywhere in the base.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A National Spectrum Management and 5G Strategy closed its inception workshop with methodology, work plan and governance structures agreed. The strategy is donor-financed through the regional digital integration project and consultant-led (strategy). No draft, spectrum award or timetable follows it. It is the only forward-looking connectivity instrument in this unit that is not a fibre route, and it is being written by external consultants inside a project the same lender finances.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	Government data-hosting and cloud guidelines are recorded as unpublished, unchanged from a 2022 baseline against a 2028 target. They are a results indicator of the regional digital integration project and the lender records them as unpublished (guidelines). That absence bears directly on the national data centre and the international gateway, both operated by the same private company, and on the question of where government data currently sits – which nothing published answers.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A government enterprise architecture is in commissioning; no adopted interoperability framework exists. The ministry's own current-projects page lists hiring a firm to develop the architecture and its implementation plan as active work under the regional digital integration project (projects). Procurement for the consulting service was launched in May 2026 (tender). A tender is the earliest stage a roadmap can be at. Nothing adopted, sequenced or dated exists behind it, and the exchange layer it would govern is separately recorded as not established.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	No national artificial-intelligence strategy, policy or programme is held, and the ministry named infrastructure, a data centre and skills as prerequisites in April 2025. The undersecretary's statement of prerequisites is the whole of the record (prerequisites). Naming a data centre as a prerequisite is consistent with the rest of this ledger, where the national facility's own construction status is contested between two ministerial accounts and no procurement record exists.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	<i>Not held</i>, searched 2026-09-06 - the regulator's own position is that data may be held abroad without loss of sovereignty. Speaking on a data sovereignty panel in November 2025, the authority's Assistant Director for Cybersecurity said countries including South Sudan can store data abroad without compromising sovereignty, through mechanisms such as data embassies (position). That is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one: no localisation mandate exists and none is being pursued. The only instrument in prospect is a data protection framework still in drafting.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A data governance strategy went to procurement in June 2026, the enabling step behind a future exchange layer. The ICT ministry launched a consultancy tender under the regional digital integration project to design and develop the strategy, with bids closing on 30 June 2026 (tender). No award, draft or adoption date follows it. Two of the three instruments a data-governance regime needs - the strategy and the enterprise architecture - are at tender stage at once, and the third, a data protection statute, is recorded separately as not held.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	An open data portal runs at the statistics bureau on public, registered and restricted tiers; no whole-of-government policy exists. The bureau's resources page describes an operational portal with publicly accessible datasets, visualisation, multi-format download and interface access, on three data-access tiers (portal). It is scoped to statistical data. No open data policy binding ministries generally, no licence statement and no dataset inventory outside the bureau's own catalogue appears in the base.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	No data-protection statute or commission exists, only a constitutional privacy right, and the minister states a bill will come after a policy bill drafted in October 2025. What stands is the Transitional Constitution's privacy article and nothing else: no statute and no commission as at August 2026 (absence). The minister stated in December 2025 that a bill will come in 2026, and a policy bill was drafted in October 2025 by a civil-society partnership (statement, feature, drafting). Meanwhile a biometric payroll register, a humanitarian biometric registration and a planned universal digital identity are all being built with no statute governing any of them.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	A Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act was signed in February 2026, criminalising false information, online impersonation and hate speech alongside hacking, and the text is withheld. The bill passed in November 2025 and was signed on 18 February 2026, with the ministry setting out its operation the following day (signature, passage, operation, effect). The speech offences and the withheld text are the objections on record. The country has no data-protection statute, no privacy commission and no incident response team, so the first computer-crime statute is also the first digital statute of any kind. Its text cannot be read because there is no operating gazette, which is recorded separately.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The Nationality Act 2011 is the operative statute, creating the register of nationals and the certificate issued from it. The Act establishes the Directorate of Nationality, Passports and Immigration and requires it to maintain a Register of South Sudanese Nationals; the Nationality Certificate is the credential it creates (Act). No statute governs the national identity card, biometric capture or identity verification as such. The card programme recorded separately runs under an administrative mandate, not a digital identity law, and the base holds no bill that would supply one.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	A National Payment System Bill went to a five-day validation workshop in August 2026, with no text, introduction date or parliamentary timetable held. The workshop opened on 10 August 2026 (workshop, transition, bill). The separately recorded national instant payment system has been planned since early 2025 and has not moved, so the statute and the rail are both at the stage of intention.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	An ICT Authority is being established while awaiting legislation, and a May 2026 account states the President already signed its legal framework; the two are unreconciled. Both accounts trace to one speaker. In May 2026 the minister said the law is out already and signed by the President; in August 2026 he was reported standing the body up while parliamentary legislation is awaited (establishment, framework). No bill, act, presidential order or gazette entry can be found. The justice ministry's law collection stops at 2017 and omits the cybercrime Act too, the Office of the President publishes no decrees, and the Assembly's bills register stops in 2023 — so the registers are not current enough for their silence to settle anything. The division of competence with the existing communications regulator is unstated. The qualified status is the resting state.	MIXED an ICT Authority reported both as legally established and as awaiting legislation, from the same speaker
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	No artificial intelligence statute: the Cybercrimes and Computer Misuse Act 2026 is the closest instrument, enacted citing AI-enabled abuse. The legislature passed the bill on 25 November 2025, with the ICT minister giving artificial intelligence being used to discredit and abuse people as a reason for it (passage), and the President signed it into law on 18 February 2026 (Act). The Act is technology-neutral - hacking, identity theft, cyberstalking, cyberbullying, false or misleading information - with no artificial-intelligence or deepfake provision of its own (explainer). A general cybercrime law invoked against a specific harm is not regulation of that harm.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A national e-commerce strategy is recorded as non-existent in the regional project's seventh implementation report. The lender records it as non-existent (strategy). The same report records the same absence for two other parties to the project, so three parties have none between them.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The National Bureau of Statistics Act 2024 superseded the 2011 Act, though its text is not published. The bureau's own legal-framework page identifies the 2024 Act, assented in November 2024, as its principal legislation, superseding the 2011 Southern Sudan Centre for Census, Statistics and Evaluation Act (framework). The Director General briefed the Vice President's office in September 2025 with the Act as one of two documents discussed alongside a census development tool (briefing). The Act's full text is not reachable through the bureau's pages or the justice ministry's laws index, which still lists only the 2011 Act. A statute in force that a citizen cannot read is the standing condition of much of this base.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	A technical committee was given fourteen days in January 2026 to launch an Official Gazette and clear a publication backlog of every law since 2011, and no edition is on file. The committee was formed by the President on 12 January 2026 (committee). A protocol issued the week before classifies all documents bearing the President's signature as privileged executive communication that cannot be photographed, scanned or shared online. Those two facts together are the single most consequential entry in this ledger. A country with no operating gazette and a rule against reproducing signed instruments cannot have its laws read, which is why the ICT Authority's status is unresolvable and why the cybercrime Act's text is withheld.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	Data protection authority	<i>Not held</i>, searched 2026-09-06 - the communications regulator carries information protection and data privacy among its functions in the absence of an authority. The authority's own overview describes its statutory mandate under the National Communication Act 2012 as including information protection and data privacy, alongside its telecommunications, broadcasting and postal regulatory role (overview). A civil-society organisation convened a two-day workshop in May 2026 with the regulator, members of parliament and the UN mission's legal unit to review and validate version 1.0 of the Data Protection Bill 2025 (workshop). A sector regulator holding a privacy function inside a telecoms mandate is not a data protection authority, and the argument that a bill alone would not create one is made separately in the research recorded elsewhere.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	National data protection readiness	A Data Protection Bill reached version 1.0 and a validation workshop; no statute and no authority exists. Civil society convened the regulator, members of parliament and the UN mission's legal unit over two days in May 2026 to review and validate the bill (workshop). Against that, the regulator's own overview shows the privacy function still sitting inside a telecoms mandate (overview), and a research organisation has argued that what the country needs is a genuinely independent and resourced authority rather than a bill alone (analysis). Readiness here means one drafted bill and one borrowed function.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	A ministerial visit to a continental telecommunications union produced a pledge of collaboration rather than an instrument. The visit was made to the union's regional headquarters in August 2026, and no workplan, contribution or membership status is stated (visit). It is recorded as a pledge rather than an instrument. Against a country whose fibre backbone is untendered, whose spectrum strategy is consultant-led and whose gateway is privately operated, a ministerial visit is the whole of the regional engagement the base can date.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	A Smart Africa declaration of trust was signed in May 2025, committing to cooperation on the digital economy, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence. The declaration is the country's own signed act on regional digital cooperation, announced by the ICT ministry (declaration). The regulator carried the same theme to a regional panel in November 2025 on data governance and sovereignty (panel). Neither is harmonisation of law. No regional instrument has been transposed, and the domestic statutes that would carry a harmonised rule - data protection, electronic transactions - do not exist. A three-day workshop on domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework was convened in Juba for 8 to 10 September 2026 by the African Union Commission, AUDA-NEPAD, GIZ and KICTANet. Nothing establishes an outcome, a workplan or that domestication has been adopted as government policy.	ADVANCED

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Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A cross-border digital connectivity memorandum with a neighbour is recorded as delivered, and a regional satellite feasibility study opened a joint funding account. The memorandum is recorded as delivered in the regional project's implementation report, and the signing date is not stated in it (memorandum). Partner states opened a joint funding account for a communications satellite feasibility study with deposits due 30 September 2026; neither the study's cost nor each state's share was disclosed (study). The country's fibre backbone runs through the same neighbour, so the memorandum is the legal frame under which its international capacity will arrive.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	Two exploratory meetings in two months - a central bank discussion on cross-border payments and an IGAD steering committee hosted in Juba. The central bank and a Kenyan development body explored a cross-border payments system among East African Community members at a Juba meeting on 19 May 2026, with no agreement signed (meeting). The regional body's third project steering committee, on harmonised digital policies and interoperable digital financial systems, met in Juba on 30 June and 1 July 2026 and was opened by the deputy ICT minister (committee). No transfer rule exists domestically to be harmonised with. The regulator's stated position, recorded separately, is that data may be held abroad.	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards	A circular under a presidential order requires the regulator's licensees to integrate with a single national service platform. The circular, issued under the Presidential Order on Digital Government Services and e-Service Integration, mandates technical integration with the national platform for regulatory payments and services (circular). The civil registry directorate separately announced plans in July 2026 to digitise civil registration and link it to the national identity system, coordinating three ministries (plans). Both are sector directives. No whole-of-government interoperability standard, profile or specification is published, and the architecture that would define one is at tender.	ADVANCED
Standards	National quality standards	The standards bureau is developing a metrology framework to verify mobile data consumption independently. The bureau announced at World Metrology Day in May 2026 that it is building a regulatory and metrology framework to measure and verify mobile data consumption, coordinating with the communications regulator before engaging operators (framework). Its constituting statute gives it a council, standard-setting powers and conformity assessment and quality-mark functions (Act); the communications regulator's incident response team adopted a National Cyber Incident Management Framework in November 2025 on central coordination, mandatory reporting and national visibility (incident framework). Independent verification of what an operator bills for would be the first consumer-facing quality standard in this base. It is at planning stage.	ADVANCED

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Standards	Adoption of international standards	The regulator committed to the Common Alerting Protocol in May 2026, under a regulation that already lets it recognise foreign approvals. The 2016 type approval regulation, made under the National Communications Act 2012, establishes type approval and acceptance and expressly permits the regulator to recognise foreign national regulatory authorities' standards and equipment approvals (regulation). As the country's focal point for the international telecommunications union's early warning pillar, the regulator held a national workshop and committed to adopting the Common Alerting Protocol for standardised multi-channel alerts, backed by a planned US\$2.8 million emergency operations centre investment (commitment). Recognising others' approvals is cheaper than writing standards, and it is what this base shows the country doing.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	The national internet governance forum convened in Juba in 2026, the standing route for non-governmental voices into ICT policy. The forum's secretariat describes it as the standing national multistakeholder platform, open to private sector, civil society and academia and stated to support national policy discussion (forum). The 2026 national forum convened in Juba with government, private sector, civil society, academia and development partners deliberating cybersecurity, digital rights and data protection, with outcomes stated to feed national policy (2026 forum). A civil-society organisation separately convened the regulator, members of parliament and the UN mission's legal unit to validate the Data Protection Bill in May 2026 (workshop). No record shows what any of it changed in a text.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The regulator ordered internet service providers to block social media for 30 to 90 days, a power exercised without a published legal basis. The information technology minister denied two documents alleging a US\$15m influence-buying transfer by the firms contracted for the e-government programme (report). The documents' authenticity is contested and the base holds no independent verification. The order was issued in January 2025 (order). No statutory basis, appeal route or duration determination is published for it. The cybercrime Act signed a year later criminalises false information, online impersonation and hate speech, so the same period saw both an administrative blocking power exercised and speech offences enacted, neither with a readable instrument behind it.	REGRESSED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	An SSP 7 trillion budget was approved for FY2025/26 with no digital line disclosed, above a statutory fund that has no published balance. The Council of Ministers approved the budget on 14 November 2025, and no dedicated information and communications technology or digital transformation line is disclosed in it (budget). The statutory mechanism is the Universal Service and Access Fund, constituted under the National Communication Act 2012 and funded by appropriations, licensee levies and other domestic revenue (Act); the ICT ministry's fourteenth leadership meeting in September 2025 estimated a budget to support the fund and the Access to Information Commission, without stating an amount or source (meeting). A fund with no published balance and a budget with no visible line is the whole domestic financing picture.	ADVANCED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	An air traffic management system loan of US\$271,154,617 is the largest single tracked commitment on this ledger, at year precision. The commitment is dated to the year only (loan). It dwarfs every digital instrument recorded here, and nothing on file records disbursement, delivery or an operating system against it.	NO CHANGE
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	A US\$20.61 million political risk guarantee was disclosed to crowd private money into the platform powering 499 mobile network sites. A development financier disclosed a US\$10 million cumulative mezzanine and loan commitment to the energy-as-a-service company powering those sites (investment), and a guarantee agency disclosed a proposed US\$20.61 million political risk guarantee to crowd private equity and shareholder-loan investment into the same platform, still at proposed status (guarantee). A mobile operator's infrastructure subsidiary separately secured a fifteen-year licence effective 16 October 2025 to build national and cross-border fibre under a pan-African platform publicly described as a US\$320 million programme (licence). Every instrument on record de-risks one operator's network. None finances a public digital system.	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A regional digital integration project issued its seventh implementation report after a mid-term review, and private-sector investment mobilised under it has not moved. The project was approved in May 2023 and finances the spectrum and 5G strategy work as well as the fibre programme; its report is also the source for four separate absences recorded in this unit — cloud guidelines, an e-commerce strategy, an incident response team, and a cross-border memorandum (project). Private-sector investment mobilised under it has not moved (investment). One lender's implementation report is doing most of the work of a national statistical record here, which is a limit on this reading as much as a finding about the country.	MIXED a regional project financing the backbone, the spectrum strategy and the payroll register while private investment mobilised has not moved

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	A fifteen-year operator licence was awarded in April 2025, while a coverage extension expected from February 2026 has not been delivered. The licence was awarded in April 2025 (licence), and an operator launched embedded subscriber identity service in January 2025 (service). The coverage extension to one administrative area was expected from February 2026 and has not arrived. Operators are reported as citing doubts about revenue from the area, and no operator statement is held (coverage). That is the market answer to a low-income rural area with no universal service instrument to override it, and this base holds no such fund for the country.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	Internet users and penetration were reported by the regulator in July 2025, and no later national measurement is held. The figures are the regulator's own (figures). Thirteen months without a further measurement, in a period covering two tariff adjustments and a licence award, means the direction of use since then is unknown.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Three tariff adjustments on exchange-rate grounds brought Parliament to summon the information minister, after an operator cut tariffs 25 per cent in December 2025. The adjustments ran through 2026 in three phases and no regulator determination, tariff schedule or operator justification is published; Parliament moved to summon the minister on 21 August 2026 (summons, phase three, phase two, second, operator, first). An operator cut tariffs by 25 per cent in December 2025 with the ministry pressing for more (cut), and the revised rates after the adjustments are unpublished (price, editorial). So the direction is a cut followed by three rises, none of which can be quantified from anything published.	REGRESSED
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	A commercial fibre project moved to execution in early 2026, and the state backbone programme states fibre tendering starting in the second half of 2026. The commercial project holds a fifteen-year licence and moved to execution with a local partner in early 2026 (execution, licence). The state programme runs about 2,400 km through a neighbour (tendering); the design budget and route length are the government's own figures, and the lender's implementation report puts tendering in the second half of 2026 (tendering, network, design, route). Neither has laid cable on any record held.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	The international gateway is operated by a Swiss company which also holds the national data centre, under an oversight committee constituted with it. One privately held foreign company holds both the country's international gateway and its national data centre (gateway). No concession terms, duration, revenue share or performance condition is published for either. That concentration — international transit and national hosting in the same private hands — is stated in the record and nowhere explained.	NO CHANGE

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Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	<i>Not held</i>, searched 2026-09-06 - exchange point coverage and peering efficiency both score zero, and the first exchange is being built. The internet resilience index scores exchange point coverage at zero out of a hundred and peering efficiency at zero out of a hundred as at July 2025, on registry and peering-database sources; a registered South Sudan exchange number sits with the communications authority with no members, prefixes or traffic (index). A peering roadshow ran in June 2025, the local internet society chapter now leads implementation of the country's first exchange, and external technical assistance was planned for the last quarter of 2025 (update). Zero peering means every domestic exchange of traffic leaves the country and comes back.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	No satellite broadband licence, authorisation or access terms are held; one account names a rural partnership and nothing more. One account names a rural satellite partnership and no licence, authorisation or access terms are held (account). In a country whose fibre backbone is untendered and whose coverage extensions are refused on revenue grounds, the absence of any satellite licensing record is a gap in what can be said rather than evidence that no service exists.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	The national data centre was described as halfway complete in April 2026, while the regulator in January described the operator as managing critical data centre infrastructure in the present tense. The two accounts do not agree and the later one reports less progress (halfway, interest). Both are ministerial or summit statements. No construction record exists in any reachable published source: the regulator's publications page carries five documents and none concerns it, the ministry publishes nothing after December 2025, and the operator has made no statement. It is not donor-financed — the lender's project carries no data-centre workstream — so no procurement record exists where one normally would, and the operator is a privately held Swiss company of about nine people that files no public accounts. An oversight committee for gateway services and the data centre was constituted with that same company in January 2026, and no output from it is on record (committee).	MIXED a national data centre described as halfway complete in April 2026 after being described as operating in January, with no construction record in any reachable source
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	One nationally owned facility: a Tier 2 data centre at Hai Malakal in Juba, commissioned in 2019. A South Sudanese-owned operator runs the centre, offering colocation, hosting, data management, backup and replication (operator). No capacity figure, rack count, power rating or customer list is published, and the company's own page carries no date - the position is as retrieved on 29 August 2026. It is the only nationally owned facility in the base.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	A redundant site for the financial management system was contracted and fully paid at US\$1,338,685 and was not confirmed functional at audit. The Auditor General's December 2025 finding records a redundant site of equal configuration to the primary micro data centre, contracted and fully paid at US\$1,338,685, not confirmed functional at the date of audit and not verified for environmental or safety compliance, with management stating implementation was still in progress (audit). This is the only off-site backup arrangement named anywhere in the base, and it is the government's own auditor who reports it unfinished. No backup arrangement is published for any other national system.	STALLED
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	Demand of about 300 MW against about 130 MW of supply, half of it operational, all thermal, with no transmission network. The sector diagnostic records national demand at about 300 MW against about 130 MW of supply with only about half operational, generation entirely thermal, no transmission network, and an access rate of 6.7 per cent (diagnostic). The energy ministry inspected a 37 MW solar plant at Nesitu in February 2026 with 20 MW already available and a four-month timeline to reach the Juba grid (plant), and reported in August 2026 that transmission works were advancing to bring Ugandan hydropower to Juba through Nimule, with a distribution substation already built at Nesitu (transmission). Nothing in the base addresses power or water at any data centre site directly. The one nationally owned facility sits on this supply.	ADVANCED
Energy	Grid reliability	A solar-hybrid telecom energy programme took a US\$5m follow-on investment, bringing one investor's total to US\$10m. The programme is backed by a European sustainable development fund, and the site and coverage figures are the investor's and operator's own (follow-on, investment). Powering tower sites off-grid is the precondition for the coverage extensions the market has declined to fund, and this is the only energy instrument in the ledger.	ADVANCED
Energy	Rural electrification	98.3 per cent of rural households have no electricity; two connections completed in one week of August 2026. A nationwide survey of 1,261 households and 281 institutions found national electricity access at 5.4 per cent, 94.7 per cent of households with no access and 98.3 per cent of rural households with none, 1.72 per cent reached by off-grid solar, and no formal national electrification strategy in place (survey). A project connecting more than 400 customers in the border town of Nimule on imported Ugandan power launched on 15 August 2026 (Nimule), and a 150 kWp solar plant with 200 kWh of battery storage was handed over two days later delivering continuous power to a regional reference laboratory in Northern Bahr el Ghazal (laboratory). Four hundred customers against a rural population almost entirely unserved is the scale the base records.	ADVANCED
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	A biometric registration of public servants entered its third phase for the organised forces, siloed from any identity layer and governed by no data-protection authority. The third phase launched in June 2026, backed by the lender and aimed at purging ghost workers and duplicate names (phase, drive). It is siloed from any identity layer and no data-protection authority governs it. Biometric capture of the armed and uniformed services, with no statute, no controller and no retention rule, is the most sensitive collection in this ledger.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	Four ministry staff completed overseas training in June 2026, against a portfolio with no centralised data management. A World Bank supervision mission records an e-services portal operating with limited backend interoperability, no centralised data management system, and an enterprise architecture and national data exchange and governance strategy still to be developed (mission). Four staff of the ICT ministry and the universal service fund completed a public-service digital expansion training programme in Wuhan and reported back to the minister (training), and renovation began in August 2026 on three government-owned digital skills centres in Central Equatoria under a five-year programme (centres). Four people is the entire completed capacity-building event in this period. No staffing figure or skills audit for any government system is published.	ADVANCED
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	A Digital Financial Services Security Lab was stood up with the regulator, the central bank and an international body, while no national incident response team is established. The lab was stood up in March 2026 (lab). No national computer security incident response team is established, recorded as such by the lender in June 2026 (team). So the country has a sector-specific security capability for payments and no national one, a year after enacting its first computer-crime statute.	MIXED a financial-services security lab stood up while no national incident response team exists

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	Not held, searched 2026-09-06 - a supervision mission records no centralised data management system behind the e-services portal. The mission records the portal existing with limited backend interoperability, no centralised data management system, and a government enterprise architecture and national data exchange and governance strategy still to be developed under the regional digital integration project (mission). The architecture that would define an exchange is at tender, recorded separately. A portal without a layer behind it is a front door onto nothing shared.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	Identity registration is being pushed into other services - school-based registration and an integrated registry memorandum. School-based national identity registration launched in August 2026 (schools), and the immigration directorate's head set out a digital reform programme with a memorandum on an integrated registry (reform). Mobile registration kits were deployed from April 2026 (kits), and the civil registry directorate announced plans to link civil registration to the identity system for real-time birth registration (plans). All of it is registration reaching further, not the identity being consumed by another system. No verification interface, no relying party and no authentication volume is named.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	An electronic logistics system reached 105 of 145 health facilities with its dashboard integrated into the national health instance. The national health management information system has run on DHIS2 since 2020, with integration of health-programme data into it recorded as in progress and only 22.4 per cent of health facilities holding comprehensive facility-wide electronic systems (assessment). The electronic logistics management system reached 105 of 145 facilities with a dashboard integrated into that instance (integration), and a custom dashboard began piloting climate-informed predictive modelling inside it in July 2026 (dashboard). Two applications integrated into one national instance is real interoperability, and it is confined to health.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	The education data landscape is largely manual and fragmented with limited interoperability; a costed reform plan was produced in March 2026. Four parallel education data systems were assessed against a common framework and found to diverge on coverage, frequency and accessibility, with harmonised indicators and stronger cross-system coordination called for (assessment). A continental education body and the education ministry then documented the landscape as largely manual and fragmented across multiple systems with limited integration between data streams and limited interoperability (diagnostic), and produced a costed national action plan over three days covering capacity development, data quality, infrastructure and system integration, governance and decentralisation (plan). The problem is named and priced. Nothing yet connects the four systems.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	The beneficiary registry reached 87,867 households but remains project-scoped rather than a shared registry. A World Bank project paper describes a government-led management information system linked to biometric beneficiary registration, project-scoped rather than a standalone universal social registry (paper). By September 2025 it had biometrically registered and paid 87,867 households, 615,069 people, across 15 counties (scale). Nothing reads from it but the project that built it. No other programme, ministry or register is recorded drawing on the same data.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A unified national digital identity system was announced for every citizen aged 18 and over, against a base in which close to 90 per cent of the population holds no government-recognised identification. The announcement came in July 2026 alongside the civil registry plan (announcement, records). Five machine systems were delivered in May 2026, two for passports and three for identity and nationality documents (machines). The production capacity is therefore arriving before the statute, the data-protection law, the register design and the fee structure that would decide who can actually use it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	School-based national identity registration was launched for examination candidates, against a nationality certificate held by about 10 per cent of the population. Registration was launched at a secondary school in August 2026 with expansion to more schools planned, following card collections in one region (school, collection, issuance). The stated fee is over 50,000 South Sudanese pounds (school). About 10 per cent of the population holds a nationality certificate (certificate); stock held and cards issued are reported on different bases across sources and no single reconciled coverage figure exists (certificate). A personal identity card required for banking, land transactions and court processes stood at 380,000 held by the directorate in January 2026 (card). A fee at that level, on those coverage figures, is the access question this unit does not address.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	Passport stock and clearance figures were given at a directorate handover, and a new-generation passport is announced for August 2027 on a validity change with no amending instrument on file. The stock and clearance claims are the outgoing officeholder's own, made at his own handover; the annual applicant figure and a month-long delay are the incoming officeholder's (handover, testimony, booklets, resumption). The new-generation and regional passport is announced for August 2027; ten-year validity would require amending the passport act, the handover was reported as having extended adult validity already, and no amending instrument is on file while the directorate's own account puts the change before the Assembly (passport, roadmap). A validity change reported as done and simultaneously as pending is the same unreadable-instrument problem the gazette entry describes.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	Registration is being extended - school-based and by mobile kit - with no verification service on record. School-based national identity registration launched in August 2026 (schools) and mobile registration kits were deployed from April 2026 (kits). The immigration directorate's head set out a digital reform programme with a memorandum on an integrated registry (reform). Enrolment is not authentication. No verification interface, no relying party and no transaction count appears in the base, and the identity legislation recorded separately does not provide for one.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	The civil registry directorate announced plans to link birth registration to the identity system for real-time registration. The directorate announced plans to digitise civil registration and link it to the national identity system for real-time birth registration, coordinating the health, justice and interior ministries, in response to recommendations in an identity diagnostic (plans). A plan with three ministries named and no instrument behind it. No birth registration rate, no pilot and no timetable is published against it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	The two sit in one directorate and are not yet linked; a plan to connect them was announced in July 2026. The Directorate of Civil Registry, Nationality, Passport and Immigration holds both functions and announced plans to digitise civil registration and link it to the identity system, coordinating three ministries (plans). The statutory basis for the identity side is the Nationality Act 2011, which requires the directorate to maintain a register of nationals (Act). Institutional unity has not produced technical connection. No figure is held for births registered and identity records created from one event.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	Identity registration is reaching schools, which is distribution rather than a system consuming the identity. School-based national identity registration launched in August 2026, taking enrolment to where the population already gathers (schools). More than 4,000 processed cards and passports were distributed across the four counties of Greater Yei from July 2026 with European Union support (distribution). No second system reads the identity. Every record here is the identity programme extending itself.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank affirmed mobile money as legal tender, and the national instant payment system has been at roadmap stage since early 2025. The affirmation was made under a 2017 electronic money regulation; the target of 30 per cent adult usage by 2027 is the central bank's own, and economists called the declaration premature in an economy over 90 per cent cash-based (affirmation, reactions). Roadmap development for the instant payment system was announced in February 2025 after a 2023 proof of concept, and nothing has moved since (roadmap). A declaration of legal tender ahead of the rail that would clear it is the sequencing this unit repeats across identity, payments and law.	MIXED mobile money affirmed as legal tender while the instant payment rail that would carry it has not moved since 2025
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	87,867 households were biometrically registered and paid across 15 counties under one social protection project. The beneficiary management information system, linked to biometric registration, had registered and paid 87,867 households - 615,069 people - across 15 counties by September 2025 (scale). It remains project-scoped rather than a universal social registry (paper). This is the country's only government-to-person payment channel of any size, and it belongs to a donor-financed project rather than to a national payments architecture.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	Cash payment of tax at revenue offices was barred with immediate effect in July 2026, after cash was abolished for passport and identity payments in January. The economic reform committee ordered banks to enforce cash tax payments (directive), reversing the direction the cashless measure set. The tax measure was made by resolution of a ministerial committee on economic reform, framed by the authority as a transparency and liquidity response and stated as temporary until further notice (resolution). Cash was abolished for passport and identity payments after a supply crisis in January 2026 (passports). Both are removals of the cash channel rather than additions of a digital one, in an economy widely described as overwhelmingly cash-based, and neither states an assisted or offline route for anyone without an account.	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	An interbank payment and settlement system launched with 13 banks and all licensed banks mandated by January 2026, and its real-time settlement component reported exceptional uptake. The system launched in October 2025 with all licensed banks mandated onto it by 31 January 2026. It is wholesale settlement infrastructure rather than a retail instant rail, and the retail framing used at launch was promotional (launch, explainer). The settlement component's uptake was reported as exceptional by the central bank and the finance ministry, with no volume or value figure attached (uptake). Wholesale settlement working while the retail rail has not started is the correct order, and the launch framing obscured it.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	A domestic financial technology company launched a multi-currency payments application in March 2026, alongside the operator mobile money services. A Juba-headquartered company founded in 2024 launched a stablecoin-backed multi-currency payments application on the App Store (application). Government revenue collection was separately routed through an electronic system by presidential order, endorsed for enforcement in March 2026 (order). No transaction volume, user count or interoperability arrangement is published for any channel, so the base can name the rails and not their use.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Mobile money operators pledged nationwide agent expansion with the central bank, and 1,225 entrepreneurs graduated from an operator training programme. The expansion pledge was made in August 2025 and no agent count, coverage figure or subsequent report is held (pledge, safeguard). The training graduation is the operator's own account, with no seed-funding total and no measure of what the training changed (training). Against an economy that remains overwhelmingly cash-based, neither a pledge nor a graduation count establishes uptake.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Bilateral support for financial technology was reported in August 2026, with no instrument, envelope, workstream or timetable stated. The support was reported in August 2026 (support). The base holds no domestic payment system for it to attach to: the instant rail is at roadmap stage and the payment system bill is at validation workshop.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	The standards bureau is building a framework to verify mobile data billing independently - the first consumer-facing measure in this base. The bureau announced at World Metrology Day in May 2026 that it is developing a regulatory and metrology framework to measure and verify mobile data consumption, coordinating with the communications regulator before engaging operators (framework). It is at planning stage and covers data, not payments. No complaints route, refund duty, dispute mechanism or loss-allocation rule for a payments customer appears anywhere in the base.	ADVANCED
Registries	Population register	The Register of South Sudanese Nationals is statutory, and more than 4,000 cards were distributed across Greater Yei in July 2026. The Nationality Act 2011 establishes the directorate and requires it to maintain the register, with the Nationality Certificate as the credential (Act). Distribution of more than 4,000 processed national identity cards and passports began in Yei River County covering the four counties of Greater Yei, with European Union support (distribution). No national coverage figure exists. A county-level distribution count is the most precise measure of the register the base holds.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	A centralised civil registration system was announced with health facilities notifying births, one issuing authority and compulsory death registration, against birth registration coverage that has not moved. The announcement came in July 2026 (announcement, statelessness). Birth registration coverage has not moved on the figures held, which come from an identity diagnostic and a statelessness study rather than from a national series (coverage, study). Making death registration compulsory and centralising issuance are both enforcement designs, and neither the register nor the statute behind it exists yet.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register	<i>Not held</i>, searched 2026-09-06 - the statutory duty to establish addresses and postal codes has stood unused since 2012. The National Communication Act 2012 requires the Authority to establish a national postal system for addresses and postal codes (Act). No address register, postcode scheme or addressing project is recorded under it. Fourteen years of an unexercised statutory duty is the finding, and it bears on every service that would need to reach a household.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Business register	The Companies Act 2012 creates a statutory Register of Companies and an office of Registrar; nothing else about it is published. The Act establishes the register and the Registrar (Act). No registration count, digital filing route, search interface or turnaround figure appears in the base. The register exists in law and is invisible in practice - which is the same shape as the address register recorded separately.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Social protection register	87,867 households, 615,069 people, biometrically registered across 15 counties - project-scoped, not universal. The registry is a government-led management information system linked to biometric beneficiary registration, described in its financing paper as project-scoped rather than a standalone universal social registry (paper). It had registered and paid 87,867 households across 15 counties by September 2025 (scale). Fifteen counties of eighty. No plan to widen it into a national registry, and no other programme drawing on it, is recorded.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register	An election date of 22 December 2026 was set with registration to follow; as at August it had not begun. The National Elections Act 2012 requires the Commission to prepare, revise, update, approve and maintain the General Electoral Register (Act). The Commission announced 22 December 2026 as the election date and said a nationwide registration exercise, expected to take about a month, would follow (date). After assessment missions across all ten states and the three administrative areas, it said in August 2026 that registration was expected to begin soon (status). A month of registration, four months before the poll, and it had not started. No register of any size exists to update.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Tax register	A presidential order routes all government revenue through the electronic collection system, and registration is being enforced. The Taxation Act 2009 requires the revenue authority to run a registration system giving each taxpayer a unique identifying number, with registration mandatory and a certificate issued (Act). Presidential Order No. 35 of 2025, signed 3 December 2025, requires every government institution to collect and remit public revenue exclusively through the authority's electronic collection system, and its enforcement was endorsed in March 2026 (order). The domestic tax division gave taxpayers until 15 May 2026 to clear arrears and warned that unregistered businesses without an identification number are acting illegally (notice). No registered-taxpayer count is published, so the enforcement has no denominator.	ADVANCED
Registries	Land register	No digital land register programme, instrument or system is held; the record is one expert's advocacy for a central database. The advocacy was published in June 2025 in the context of land fraud (advocacy). A personal identity card is required for land transactions, so the register that would record those transactions does not exist while the credential to conduct them does.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The national health instance took on a predictive malaria dashboard in July 2026, on a system scored at 40.5 per cent maturity. The health ministry's validated self-assessment puts overall health information system maturity at 40.5 per cent, records integration of health-programme data into the national instance as in progress, and finds only 22.4 per cent of health facilities holding comprehensive facility-wide electronic systems (assessment). A custom dashboard began piloting climate-informed predictive modelling and automated malaria outbreak alerts inside the national instance in July 2026 (dashboard), and an electronic logistics system reached 105 of 145 facilities with its own dashboard integrated into it (logistics). Predictive modelling sits on top of a system three-quarters of facilities cannot feed electronically.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education	An education in emergencies management information system was launched on the same platform the health ministry has run since 2018, after training 35 master trainers. It was launched with international partners and funded by an education fund (system). Building on an instance already running for health is the only reuse of existing government infrastructure recorded in this unit, and it is donor-led.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	One management information system, linked to biometric registration and paying 87,867 households, owned by a project rather than a ministry. The system is government-led and linked to biometric beneficiary registration, described in its financing paper as project-scoped (paper). It had registered and paid 87,867 households across 15 counties by September 2025 (scale). Nothing records what happens to it when the project closes, which is the question a sectoral system in this position raises.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	<i>Not held</i>, searched 2026-09-06 - the sector's own assessment records one county with a functional formal justice system in an entire state. The most substantive assessment of policing and justice-chain capacity by state and county describes case management, police staffing and infrastructure gaps outside Juba, and records for one state that Wau remains the only county with a functional formal justice system (assessment). No case management system, procurement for one, or plan naming one appears in the base. The absence is dated and cited rather than unexamined.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	A six-year telecom revenue-assurance agreement was signed by the revenue authority and the regulator, with the vendor taking 3.56 per cent. The agreement is a build-operate-transfer arrangement (agreement). The vendor is named differently in two accounts and no source on file settles the name, which is worth stating: the party taking a percentage of telecommunications revenue for six years cannot be reliably identified from the published record.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	Electronic cargo tracking was introduced by the revenue authority for inbound goods. It was introduced in 2026 (tracking). The account reaches the base through the government's defence of the e-government concession, so the tracking system is evidenced only inside an argument about the contract that delivered it. No coverage, volume or clearance-time figure is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land	A state-level digital land registration framework is being built in Central Equatoria, against records the government itself calls handwritten. The government's own draft land policy describes land administration as weak and largely manual, records often handwritten and formal administration concentrated in a few urban centres, and sets a National Land Registry and Land Records System as a policy objective (policy). Central Equatoria State's information ministry, with the state housing and lands ministry and county authorities, is developing a unified digital land registration framework beginning with land records in Juba County (framework); a European Union and migration agency programme running in Rubkona and Yei River counties from 1 January 2026 commits to advancing the digitalisation of land records (programme). Three efforts in three places, none of them national, and the national registry the policy calls for does not exist.	ADVANCED
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	An exclusive e-Government services contract was signed in 2019 without competitive tender, with the profit share put at 75 per cent by a United Nations commission and at 2 per cent by the company. The commission puts the profit share at 75 per cent to the contractor (commission); the company says it takes a 2 per cent platform service fee, which describes a separate tax contract (commission). The two accounts have not been reconciled (commission, denial, defence, partnership). The electronic visa portal runs inside that concession, applications online only with a stated 72-hour processing time and fees denominated in United States dollars, so the charge is levied through a privately operated channel (visa). The regulator separately launched its own services platform in February 2026, digitising licensing, payments and regulatory workflows (platform).	MIXED three platforms live while the exclusive concession behind them was signed without tender and its revenue share is disputed

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	<i>Not held</i>, searched 2026-09-06 - the capacity assessment covering all ten states finds the institutions short of the basics. The assessment covers organisational structures, staffing, infrastructure and working environment across the ten states and three administrative areas, and finds gaps across them (assessment). The one thing reaching sub-national institutions in the period is a national alerting roadmap for warning dissemination (roadmap). No state or county digital service platform is recorded, and the most recent assessment of what these institutions can run is five years old.	NO CHANGE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	Central Equatoria is developing a unified digital land registration framework, the first sub-national records digitisation in the base. The state information ministry, the state housing and lands ministry and county authorities are building the framework, beginning with land records in Juba County (framework). A European Union and migration agency programme running in Rubkona and Yei River counties from 1 January 2026 commits to strengthening land governance systems and advancing the digitalisation of land records (programme), against a national policy describing records as often handwritten (policy). Land is the only record class being digitised at this level. No council register, permit system or revenue record appears.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	The first patient-level electronic register went into use across five facilities, cutting missed appointments from 58 per cent to 11 per cent. The register moved into operational use across five facilities including state hospitals at Rumbek, Yirol and Yambio, with more than 12,700 legacy records digitised and missed appointments falling from 58 per cent to 11 per cent between May 2025 and February 2026 (register). An offline-first tracker on Android devices ran a twelve-month pilot for community health workers in remote settings, replacing paper household visit, childhood-illness and immunisation follow-up reporting (tracker). Five facilities and one pilot, in a system where 22.4 per cent of facilities hold comprehensive electronic systems (assessment).	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	School reporting is still largely manual with inadequate connectivity in rural areas, against a census already collected on tablets. The annual education census collects school-level data on tablets into a web repository, covering enrolment, teachers, facilities and the availability of ICT teachers at schools nationally (census). A three-day workshop in March 2026 documented school-level reporting as still largely manual with inadequate infrastructure and connectivity especially in rural and hard-to-reach areas, and produced a costed national action plan in response (plan); 84 computers, 33 motorbikes and one vehicle were handed to the education ministry in November 2025 to strengthen monitoring and supervision (handover). An annual census on tablets and daily reporting on paper is the gap the plan prices.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	2,500 identity cards registered across the greater Yei region, from an office that lacks premises. An immigration directorate delegation to Yei River County reported 2,500 national identity cards registered across the greater Yei region to date, while recording that the county's own immigration office still lacks adequate and well-known premises (visit). Mobile registration kits were deployed from April 2026 (kits), and distribution of more than 4,000 processed cards and passports began across the four counties of Greater Yei in July (distribution). Registration is reaching the counties by kit and by visit rather than through an office that can hold it.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	Fifteen officers were trained on donated forensic equipment and tasked with training others in the states. Digital forensic laboratory equipment was donated with electronic fingerprint technology planned for a second phase, and fifteen officers trained and tasked with training additional personnel in the states (equipment). A separately funded surveillance project was approved with a first phase limited to Juba and a stated second phase to expand across the country (project), against an assessment describing case management, staffing and infrastructure gaps outside the capital (assessment). No county station is confirmed to hold any equipment, and no station-level count exists.	ADVANCED

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The ministry's own position is that infrastructure, data centres and trained people come first; the one deployment is a public e-learning platform. Speaking at a regional summit, the ministry set out three pillars - infrastructure, data centres and trained human resources - as prerequisites, and described no operational system in administration, only planned donor-funded training and fibre groundwork (pillars). A national e-learning platform launched in June 2026 by the mobile operator with an education organisation and two ministries, zero-rated on that operator's network and carrying artificial-intelligence-supported content (platform). A government-partnered public service, not an internal administration system. Nothing inside government runs on it.	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Two algorithmic systems run in production - a malaria prediction pilot inside the national health instance and a monthly food security model. A custom dashboard began piloting climate-informed predictive modelling and automated malaria outbreak alerts inside the national health instance in July 2026 (dashboard). The food security monitor is a monthly sub-national early warning system combining conflict, price, climate and exchange-rate data through calibrated transformations and a weighted generalised linear model to raise alerts and estimate populations at risk across the 78 second-level administrative areas (monitor). Both are built and run by external partners on donor systems. Neither is owned by the ministry whose sector it covers.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	No national strategy: the country adopted the regional AI declaration and the regional strategy went to validation. The ministry stated in 2024 that the country was working on establishing its own roadmap alongside other African states (roadmap). As one of eight partner states the country adopted the East African Community Declaration on Artificial Intelligence at a regional conference over 30 March to 1 April 2026, committing to a regional fund, shared infrastructure, harmonised curricula and integration of artificial intelligence into development planning (declaration); the draft regional strategy for 2026 to 2031 went to a two-day validation workshop in Kampala on 4 and 5 May 2026 (strategy). The national position is entirely carried by regional instruments.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	A national cyber-security task force was stood up in July 2026 to enforce a statute with no AI provision. The Cybercrime and Computer Misuse Act 2026, signed on 18 February 2026 and enforceable on signature, is technology-neutral - hacking, identity theft, cyberstalking, cyberbullying, false or misleading information - with no artificial-intelligence or deepfake provision (explainer). The justice minister publicly dismissed a circulating investigation report as an artificial-intelligence fabrication and warned of prosecution for creating or sharing it (case), and under a presidential directive a multi-agency task force and steering committee held its first operational meeting on 16 July 2026 to enforce the Act ahead of the December elections, including against false and misleading information (task force). A general offence of false information, enforced by a task force, in an election year.	ADVANCED
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	No domestic hardware base and a nascent software sector, against a 2,400 kilometre fibre backbone announced for construction. The country diagnostic documents a nascent digital business sector - ride-sharing, information technology support firms, technology-enabled agribusiness - with no domestic hardware manufacturing base, severe skills and infrastructure gaps and no national fibre backbone (diagnostic). Construction of a 2,400 kilometre national backbone reaching the Indian Ocean through Kenya was announced to begin in December 2025 (backbone), and a Juba-headquartered company launched a multi-currency payments application in March 2026 (application). One application on an app store is the base's clearest instance of domestic software production.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	The mobile operator opened an ICT hub in Northern Bahr el Ghazal State as a digital-skills training, scholarship and innovation facility. 2026-08-31 – the mobile operator opened the Aweil ICT Hub in Northern Bahr el Ghazal State, opened at a ceremony attended by government, education-sector, youth and development-partner representatives and described as a digital-skills training, scholarship and innovation facility. No capacity, budget, term or intake figure is published, and no public instrument stands behind it: the hub is an operator's own facility, announced by the operator, in a state where the base holds no other hub. What the record cannot say is whether it will run past the announcement.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A four-year incubator for 350 small enterprises launched in April 2026, above a pitch competition that awarded EUR 90,000. A pitch competition in Juba on 26 September 2025 saw 24 entrepreneurs compete and seven share EUR 90,000 in grants (competition). A European Union-funded incubator running 2026 to 2029 launched on 16 April 2026 at the University of Juba, targeting incubation, acceleration and finance for 350 small and medium enterprises across seven regions, 30 per cent women-led and more than half youth-led (incubator). Both are donor-financed and neither reports a company formed, funded or grown beyond its own cohort.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	Digital literacy was found low but never measured; three skills centres are under renovation. Stakeholder consultations found digital literacy low but did not tabulate it, there being no national statistics or third-party surveys, and the project responded by planning a competency framework and learning programmes for civil servants and university students (consultations). Renovation began in August 2026 on three government facilities designated as digital skills centres in Central Equatoria under a five-year programme reaching more than 8,000 people including 3,000 civil servants (centres), and four ministry staff completed a public-service digital expansion programme in Wuhan (training). Three years after the finding, the measurement still does not exist.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	No national measure exists and one has been commissioned; the best evidence is a four-site household assessment. A 2,135-household connectivity needs and usage assessment across four refugee-hosting locations, run between 15 January and 26 February 2026, found 72 per cent of respondents aware of the internet, 66 per cent of internet users unable to use it as much as they would like on grounds of cost, devices and literacy, and 41 per cent of women and 20 per cent of men unable to read and write (assessment). A government tender closing 25 June 2026 commissions a National Digital Skills Assessment with framework development and an implementation plan (tender). The household assessment covers refugee and host-community sites only and is not nationally representative, which is why the tender exists.	NO CHANGE a first count with no earlier figure behind it
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	Computing is an optional secondary subject the curriculum itself expects schools to lack facilities for; a mentorship scheme began in three schools. The national curriculum places information and communications technology among the optional secondary subjects alongside Kiswahili, French, Arabic, arts and physical education, and states that many schools lacked facilities so the subject would run as a stand-alone catch-up programme where they were absent (curriculum). A stakeholder meeting at Juba Day Secondary School in April 2026 co-created an implementation plan for a mentorship programme across three selected secondary schools, run by a telecommunications union fellow with vendor support (programme). Three schools, and a curriculum that anticipated its own non-delivery thirteen years ago.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A new public university opened with computing programmes in February 2026, extending qualifications beyond Juba. The government's own admission guide confirms computer science and information technology as faculties or specialisations at the University of Juba, which runs a four-year bachelor's degree through its own school, and at two private university colleges (guide). Bentiu University of Petroleum opened as Unity State's first public university with a bachelor's degree in computer science and a diploma in information technology approved among its initial programmes (university), and five public universities were equipped with twenty desktop computers and a projector each (equipment). Twenty computers per university is the scale of the facilities behind the qualifications.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	A state digital skills programme is costed at US\$2,806,100 for three centres training more than 8,000 people, and its intake figures differ between the partner and the minister. The implementing partner supplied the budget; the state minister put the intake at 5,000 residents and 3,000 civil servants (programme). An educational technical cooperation project committed US\$22,336,740 for a second phase in 2020 after US\$7,084,827 for a first in 2016, both year-precise and stated in dollars by the financier (second phase, first phase). Neither carries a completion, graduate or placement figure at any date.	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	Two clause-level analyses of the 2026 statutes were published from outside government; no public research programme exists. A regional information and communications technology policy think tank analysed the 2021 Cybercrimes and Computer Misuse Provisional Order, recommending court-order requirements for data access, enactment of a data protection law, ratification of the African Union convention and deletion of the offensive-communication provision (analysis). A South Sudanese civil-society chapter published a clause-level breakdown of the Cybercrimes and Computer Misuse Act 2026 covering extraterritorial jurisdiction, 180-day data retention, content-moderation duties, critical infrastructure designation and new digital-harassment offences (breakdown), and a digital rights research organisation argued for a genuinely independent and resourced data protection authority rather than a bill alone (argument). Every contribution on record is from outside government, and none is answered in a text.	ADVANCED

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	No digital channel: complaints run through the statutory grievances chamber and, from April 2026, a procurement complaints committee. The Public Grievances Chamber is the statutory citizen complaints mechanism against government institutions (Act). The procurement authority operationalised a Complaints Review Committee in April 2026 as an independent administrative review route under the 2018 Procurement Act (committee), and three community peace desks were activated in Unity State to receive concerns and housing, land and property issues, against an assessment finding 35 per cent of respondents needing guidance on how to submit a complaint and 42 per cent withholding feedback for fear of reprisal (desks). Every route on record is in person or on paper, and four in ten people will not use one.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	The state's own human rights commission rated the country weak on transparency and participation and very weak on accountability, with access to public information limited. Officials of the national human rights commission told a Juba panel on 2 September 2026 that the government treats civil society organisations as enemies or political opponents, rated the country weak on transparency and participation and very weak on accountability, and said access to public information remained limited with civil society given little opportunity to take part in government processes including preparation of the national budget (panel). Participants said the revenue authority, which is required to publish revenue-collection information, has not consistently done so, and that the body responsible for access to information lacks the staff and capacity to enforce the law (panel). No index, methodology or dated measurement sits behind the weak and very weak ratings, and the assessment is the state speaking about itself.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Gender equity	A 35 per cent quota and a gender policy stand above two bills that have not passed; two projects launched in the period. The government's own review confirms the National Gender Policy, records the anti-gender-based-violence and family law bills as both introduced in 2023 and still bills, and states a 35 per cent quota for women in government under the revitalised peace agreement (review). Two peacebuilding fund initiatives launched with the government in July 2026 reaching more than 8,000 women and young people, 2,100 of them women and girls, with leadership, livelihoods, digital empowerment and community dialogue (initiatives), and a regional project launched in Torit in August 2026 linking women's economic empowerment to land rights and governance (project). No sex-disaggregated figure for phone ownership, internet use or identity registration is published anywhere in the base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	1,400 teachers were trained in sign language and Braille across three national institutes, under a 2020 action plan. The National Disability Action Plan implements the 2015 policy and sets interventions across data management, health care, rehabilitation, education and law (plan). An education emergency fund programme trained 1,400 teachers in sign language, Braille and inclusive pedagogy at three national teacher-training institutes over two years (training), and a disability-inclusive food security training package was launched in Wau in July 2026 and in Juba later that month (package). Both reach services rather than systems. No accessibility requirement attaches to any government digital service on record.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	Large-scale biometric registration and re-registration of displaced people ran from April to June 2026, with no data-controller arrangement or retention rule stated. The exercise is a humanitarian registration rather than a state system (registration, feedback). No data-controller arrangement, retention rule, consent record or relationship to the national identity system is stated. It is the largest biometric collection in this ledger and the one furthest outside any legal framework, in a country with no data-protection statute.	ADVANCED
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	A US\$67 million regional integration project carries the connectivity programme, alongside a 2,400 kilometre backbone and solar power for 500 network sites. The regional digital integration project, at US\$67 million, is the active programme addressing connectivity and the digital divide through broadband fibre deployment (mission). The telecommunications undersecretary announced a 2,400 kilometre national backbone connecting to Kenya, intended to shift the country from expensive satellite connectivity toward terrestrial broadband reaching rural areas (backbone), and a follow-on US\$5 million investment, US\$10 million in total, financed solar-hybrid power for over 500 mobile network sites, improving reliability in areas without stable electricity (power). Every instrument here is external. None is financed domestically, and the usage divide they address is not measured.	ADVANCED

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	The first strategy ran to 2020 on a US\$58 million budget; a second is being built out through an agricultural statistics plan. The bureau's first strategy, covering 2014 to 2020, set legal and institutional, human resource capacity, statistical infrastructure and data development objectives on a US\$58 million budget (strategy). The finance minister publicly committed government support to the bureau in January 2026, covering the second strategy, legal reform, sustainable financing and administrative data (commitment), and a five-day diagnostic workshop in May 2026 produced the foundation for a Strategic Plan for Agricultural and Rural Statistics for 2026 to 2031 aligned to it (workshop). The second strategy's own text is not held. Six years after the first expired, what the base shows is work aligned to a document it cannot read.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The statistics bureau published a national population estimate, with about 2.2 million of the increase attributed to migration from a neighbouring conflict. It was published at a population day dialogue in July 2026 (estimate). It is a projection rather than an enumeration, and it is the denominator under every coverage figure in this unit — identity, nationality certificates, birth registration and internet penetration all rest on it.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	Health is the only sector publishing from administrative data - a statistical abstract of about ninety tables built on the national instance. The abstract covers health status, risk factors, service coverage and health systems indicators across about ninety tables, built on administrative health data (abstract). The health agency's 2025 annual report, organised by quarter and cluster, covers strengthened health information systems and administrative-data reporting alongside emergency response and primary health care (report). No other sector publishes a statistical product from its own administrative records, and the education, land and justice systems recorded separately have no data to publish from.	NO CHANGE
Open data	Use of open data	The first nationally representative household dataset since independence was released in April 2026, alongside a public food security dashboard. The statistics bureau and a United Nations agency released the 2025 Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey publicly with full results and detailed data (survey). The food security information system's public dashboard lets users query state-level phase populations for April to July 2026, turning a major humanitarian assessment into queryable data (dashboard), and the bureau runs an open data portal on public, registered and restricted tiers (portal). Fifteen years to a first national household dataset. Everything open in this base is statistical, and no policy requires any of it.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	Satellite-derived flood mapping carried the April 2026 outlook projecting Emergency across 34 counties and a famine risk in four. The national crop assessment triangulates field task force work and county crop monitoring committees with satellite-derived vegetation index and rainfall data from two United Nations agencies (assessment). The April 2026 food security outlook used satellite-derived flood extent mapping alongside rainfall and crop condition data to project Emergency outcomes across 34 counties and a credible risk of Famine in four through September 2026 (outlook), and a monthly monitor combines vegetation index and rainfall with conflict, price and exchange-rate data across the 78 second-level administrative areas (monitor). Every product is produced by an external agency. No national earth-observation capability appears in the base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	The observation network went from three manual stations to forty automatic ones sharing data internationally. The meteorological service had three manual observation stations covering a country larger than Kenya, with forecasters newly trained to use satellite data and global numerical weather prediction outputs (capacity). Twenty-seven further automatic weather stations were installed, bringing the total to forty sharing data on the global information system towards basic observing network compliance (stations), and a US\$2,079,598.80 investment funding request was approved in February 2026 for surface observing stations, maintenance, data and information technology systems and staff training (funding). A thirteen-fold increase in stations inside a year, entirely externally financed.	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	The e-Government contractor was sanctioned by the United States in May 2026, on a secondary-sourced account with no designation notice held. The sanction is reported secondarily and no designation notice is held (sanction). The company sanctioned is the one holding the exclusive e-government concession through which the visa portal and the tax platform run, so a sanctions designation and the state's principal digital service channel are the same entity.	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	A Chinese vendor re-engaged after a rift dating from 2014, and exploratory talks were held in Hangzhou in August 2026 with nothing contracted. The re-engagement was reported in February 2026, following stated interest in the country's digital future the previous September (re-engagement, interest). No contract, memorandum or workstream is named. The largest single commitment on this ledger is a Chinese loan for an air traffic management system, dated only to its year, so the relationship is substantial and almost entirely undocumented here. 2026-08-31 – the ICT minister held exploratory talks with a vendor vice-president in Hangzhou, on the sidelines of a China-Africa digital conference, and said the government is ready to seek the vendor's expertise in connecting public services. Participation is sought in smart cities, energy solutions and a national data hub in Juba, and the 2014 rift followed government accusations of hacked official email and forged documents, through which the vendor stayed in the market. Still no agreement, contract or figure.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	EUR 304 million was allocated 2021-2024 under the programming framework, with no digital instrument named within it. The partnership runs under the 2021-2027 programming framework and the Global Gateway strategy, with EUR 304 million allocated between 2021 and 2024 across agri-food systems, jobs and education, health, migration and governance (partnership). A further EUR 35 million of humanitarian funding was allocated in November 2025 within a EUR 143 million sub-Saharan package (humanitarian), and the Council reviewed and maintained the restrictive-measures listing of a serving minister in June 2026, updating it to reflect his move to the justice portfolio (sanctions). Development money and a sanctions listing running at once. No digital-sector instrument is named in either.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	The legislature ratified the Saudi cooperation agreement in August 2026, having rejected it three months earlier on sovereignty grounds. Four founding instruments with the United Arab Emirates - mutual investment protection, avoidance of double taxation, visa waivers and technical cooperation on training diplomats - were signed on 24 April 2019 (instruments). The legislature ratified the general cooperation agreement with Saudi Arabia signed in 2022, covering agriculture, education, mining, infrastructure, health, trade, investment, security and social development, after rejecting it in May 2026 on sovereignty grounds (ratification); the UAE aid agency signed an US\$11 million agreement with the Red Cross federation in January 2026, US\$10 million of it for refugee-hosting communities across four countries including South Sudan (agreement). No digital or data commitment appears in any of them.	ADVANCED
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	The first Foreign Office Consultations were held in December 2025, six years after the memorandum providing for them. India's bilateral brief consolidates the 2019 consultations memorandum, a December 2025 framework agreement, the first consultations round and a research association concluded in April 2026 between a Juba institute and an Indian research body (brief). The consultations were held in Juba on 4 December 2025, reviewing capacity building, health, technical and vocational training, trade and people-to-people relations, with a second round agreed for New Delhi (consultations), and a technical and vocational education partnership was launched with UNESCO and the education ministry on 31 October 2025 (partnership). Capacity building and training throughout. No digital agreement, financing or technology transfer is named on either side.	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Satellite broadband licensing and market access	A satellite-broadband licence, authorisation register or NCA decision on market access.	not yet probed
Digital land register	A land-registry digitisation programme document, procurement or ministerial decision.	not yet probed
State or county digital service delivery	A state or county digital-service platform, mandate or published local e-government plan.	not yet probed
Comprehensive data-protection statute	The Data Protection Bill as introduced, or an enacted data-protection statute and the instrument constituting its commission.	2026-08-09
Mobile coverage gap in rural counties	A coverage map, a population-coverage percentage or a universal-service obligation from the communications regulator or either operator. What the base holds instead is one community's account of messengers walking for three days to find a signal.	not yet probed
Data localisation requirements	A statute, regulation or directive requiring any class of data to be held in-country, or a published government position adopting one.	2026-09-06
Data protection authority	An Act constituting a data protection authority, or an instrument conferring the function on a named body with its own powers and budget.	2026-09-06
Internet exchange point	An exchange point with members and measurable traffic, on the regional registry or the global peering database.	2026-09-06
National data exchange system	An adopted government enterprise architecture, or a data exchange layer in production with connected agencies named.	2026-09-06
Address and postal code register	An address register, postcode scheme or addressing project established under the postal duty in the National Communication Act 2012.	2026-09-06
Court case management system	A judiciary or justice ministry record of a deployed case management system, or a procurement award for one.	2026-09-06

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Domestic capacity in digital production	A domestic hardware assembly or manufacturing operation, or a published count of digital-sector firms and their output.	2026-09-06

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.